



## Case Study

# Hitachi Academy: Building a Common Language for Project Management Across the Hitachi Group

Hitachi Academy uses PMP® certification pathways to standardize project management capability across a global enterprise.

**HITACHI**

# Executive summary

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Headquartered in Japan, Hitachi Group is a global leader in digital innovation and sustainable solutions, delivering technology and infrastructure across energy, mobility, industry, healthcare and digital systems. Hitachi doesn't operate in a single industry: it builds power plants, develops digital infrastructure, and delivers healthcare systems, rail technology, and smart city platforms across dozens of countries. In an organization so large and varied, project management isn't just a job title. It's a prerequisite for getting anything done. And as its projects grow in size and complexity, the demand for experienced, capable project professionals grows with them.

Serving as the organization's corporate university and learning arm, Hitachi Academy supports the Hitachi Group through workforce development. The Academy draws on the expertise of Hitachi in operational technology (OT), information technology (IT), and products, delivering training and professional development across disciplines including digital, IT, project management and business skills.

Hitachi Academy has held PMI® Authorized Training Partner (ATP) status since 2020, continuing a longstanding relationship with PMI that began through the Registered Education Provider (REP) program years earlier. Through this partnership, the Academy delivers a structured Project Management Professional (PMP)® certification preparation pathway serving approximately 1,100 employees annually. PMP certification is integrated into Hitachi Group's internal project manager certification framework, linking certification attainment to career progression, delivery excellence, and—in Japan's public sector—competitive bid readiness.

Hitachi's experience demonstrates how a PMI training partnership can support enterprise-wide project management capability building. By combining PMI-developed content with structured learner guidance and support, Hitachi Academy has aligned certification readiness with broader talent development and operational objectives. For organizations looking to strengthen internal capability and standardize project management excellence, Hitachi offers a compelling example of the Authorized Training Partner program's impact.

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Being a PMI ATP enables Hitachi Academy to develop the base project management skills required by the Hitachi Group PM certification system—aligned to global standards—and deliver them consistently across the entire Hitachi Group.”

**Hitachi Academy**



# The challenge

At Hitachi, project management isn't confined to one function, industry or business line. It's a core capability needed across many parts of the organization, with expectations varying based on project size, complexity and risk.

Nor does Hitachi's project complexity distribute evenly. A software implementation in one business unit looks very different from the construction of a power facility in another. But across both, and also across everything in between, experienced project managers are in demand, and the gap between what's available and what's needed is growing.

Two pressures shaped Hitachi Academy's approach to project management training. The first was the pace of change. Project management approaches don't stand still. Agile, hybrid delivery, and generative AI are reshaping what project managers need to know, and they're doing so on short cycles. Tracking those changes continuously, validating content, and delivering updated training to the Hitachi Group with both speed and quality was difficult for Hitachi Academy to sustain through internal effort alone.

The second was the need for a common language. Hitachi Group companies collaborate increasingly across business units, divisions and geographies. For that collaboration to work at scale, project management needs to function as a shared framework—one with internationally recognized standing that can travel across organizational and geographic boundaries.

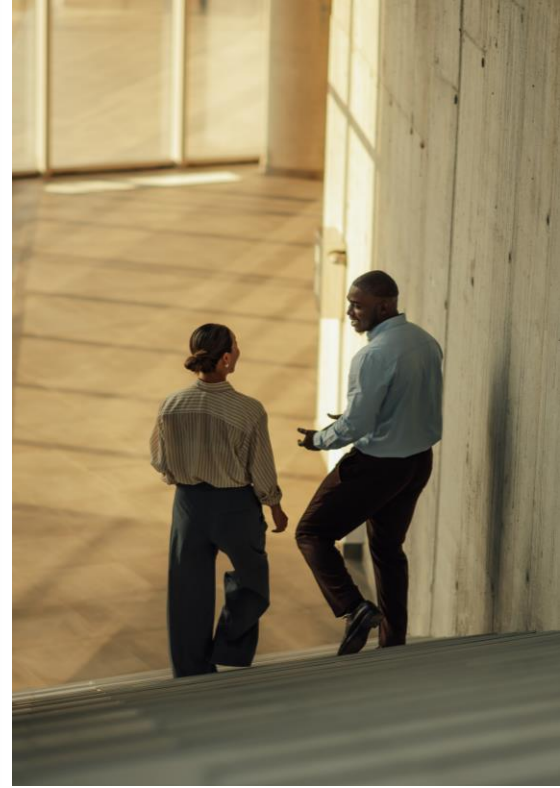
The challenge wasn't just building a high-quality training program. It was building one that could sustain itself: consistent enough to hold across a large enterprise, credible enough to carry weight with the organization's public sector clients, and flexible enough to eventually travel beyond Japan.



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"Keeping pace with rapidly evolving trends and requirements in project management—and delivering them to the Hitachi Group both quickly and with quality—is difficult to achieve internally alone. We adopted PMI's knowledge system as the common base for our internal project management standard, and build Hitachi Group-specific elements on top of that foundation."

**Hitachi Academy**



## The PMI partnership

The decision to build around PMI was driven by fit on two dimensions: international standing and organizational flexibility.

Hitachi Group companies collaborate across business lines and geographies with increasing frequency. A project management approach understood only locally creates friction at every boundary. PMI standards provided the internationally recognized base the organization needed. The ATP program offered something additional: the ability to design and operate training aligned to global standards while adapting it to Hitachi's specific business context.



We needed to provide training aligned to an internationally recognized project management framework. PMI ATP met this requirement — and could be designed and operated in a way tailored to our organizational context."

**Hitachi Academy**

### **Several aspects of the PMI partnership made the model especially valuable:**

- ✔ **Continuously updated PMI course content:** materials based on PMI standards, kept current as the discipline evolves, without requiring the Academy to build and maintain curriculum independently
- ✔ **Practical exam preparation material:** developing rigorous PMP-aligned practice questions internally would be resource-intensive; PMI Premier ATP resources address this directly
- ✔ **Dedicated PMI support and responsiveness:** As a Premier ATP, Hitachi Academy has direct access to PMI contacts for guidance and clarification, enabling faster responses and greater confidence in delivering accurate, high-quality training in a market where precision is critical.
- ✔ **Pre-approved professional development units (PDUs) for Hitachi learning content:** simplifying and supporting ongoing professional development for certified project managers already in the organization, not just those working toward initial certification
- ✔ **A quality and trust signal:** ATP status functions as external validation of program quality and relevance, both internally and with enterprise and public sector stakeholders

- ✔ **A globally portable framework:** because the content is grounded in the PMI international knowledge system, it can be extended to overseas affiliates without rebuilding from scratch

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Materials based on PMI's de facto standard knowledge system are continuously provided. Developing rigorous practice questions aligned to the PMP exam internally would be difficult. These are areas where the value of PMI is significant."

**Hitachi Academy**

## How they delivered success

### Training model

Hitachi Academy's training moves through a staged progression from foundational knowledge to real-world application, designed to match the demands of project roles across the Hitachi Group. Learning pathways are calibrated to learner roles and experience, from small-project leads to managers of large, complex initiatives. Case studies and exercises are grounded in Hitachi's business context.

The structural anchor is Hitachi Group's internal project manager certification system, which designates PMP as a prerequisite. This integration gives the program organizational weight: participation connects directly to defined career progression, not just to optional professional development.



We do not set strict participation conditions, so anyone can join. But because PMP is one requirement for becoming a project manager, many employees choose the PMP course.”

**Hitachi Academy**

The program is delivered primarily online to support access across the organization, and structured across multiple sessions to give learners time to absorb content between phases. They follow a six-day approach that includes an initial three-day block, a follow-up two-day session, and a final day focused on practice exams, Q&A, and support with the PMP application process.

### **Training includes:**

- ✓ **PMI-developed course materials** as the curriculum foundation
- ✓ **Practice exams and PMP application support** as part of the learning journey
- ✓ **Ongoing PDU-eligible programming** for certified practitioners
- ✓ **Internal funding for training**, with PMP exam funding available depending on the business entity

At Hitachi, internal training success depends not only on what’s taught, but also on the support wrapped around the learning experience. In Hitachi’s case, pacing, reinforcement, and practical learner support are key to adoption and outcomes.



# Outcomes + looking ahead

Hitachi Academy tracks program success through learning indicators like satisfaction and comprehension, as well as the number of certified project managers across Hitachi Group companies, which is monitored continuously against each company's business needs and talent strategy.

## Outcomes to date:

- ✔ **~1,100 employees** participate in PMP training annually
- ✔ **~45% of the target population** holds PMP certification, reflecting sustained participation over time
- ✔ **Growing pipeline of PM-ready talent** as PMP certification and Hitachi Group internal project management certification advance together

The organizational impact extends beyond individual credentials. When project managers share a common approach—the same terminology, the same process logic, the same ways of working toward scoping and risk—cross-functional work becomes more efficient. Hitachi Academy describes a reduction in communication loss and faster consensus formation in cross-departmental projects. Employees who previously relied on experience and intuition alone now have a shared, externally validated framework to bring to the table.

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Employees are now able to organize situations using a common framework and discuss them with stakeholders on shared premises — rather than relying solely on experience. Members from Hitachi and its group companies can now communicate using the same terminology, accelerating consensus in cross-functional projects."

**Hitachi Academy**

In Japan's public sector, the impact has a direct commercial dimension. PMP certified personnel are required in bid processes for certain public contracts, and having certified talent available supports Hitachi's competitiveness in those markets.

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In public sector projects especially, having PMP certified personnel is often a bid requirement, and this has proven effective in winning contracts."

**Hitachi Academy**

Looking ahead, the program's global architecture is its next opportunity. Training is currently delivered within Japan, but the foundation is already internationally portable, and ATP content is available in 10 core languages. When Hitachi Academy extends the program to overseas affiliates, the same framework can be deployed rather than rebuilt.

# Key takeaways

For organizations exploring whether the ATP program can support internal training goals, Hitachi's experience suggests several practical lessons:

- ✓ **A shared project management framework supports team collaboration and business outcomes.** Common terminology and process logic across teams and divisions speeds up consensus, reduces miscommunication, and makes cross-functional collaboration more efficient.
- ✓ **PMI brings what's hardest to build internally:** currency and rigor. Continuously updated courseware and exam-quality practice materials are difficult to develop and maintain in-house. ATP access addresses both.
- ✓ **ATP status signals quality externally.** For stakeholders inside and outside the organization, ATP authorization provides assurance of program quality and alignment to global standards.
- ✓ **Training connected to career pathways succeeds.** When PMP is a prerequisite for internal PM pathways, not just a standalone credential, participation carries organizational backing and drives learner motivation.
- ✓ **Internal learner support matters.** Application guidance, practice resources, pacing and follow-up can significantly strengthen the value of authorized training.
- ✓ **Build once, deploy globally.** For multinational organizations, a PMI-grounded program travels easily. Extending to new geographies is expansion, not reinvention.

# Why ATPs succeed

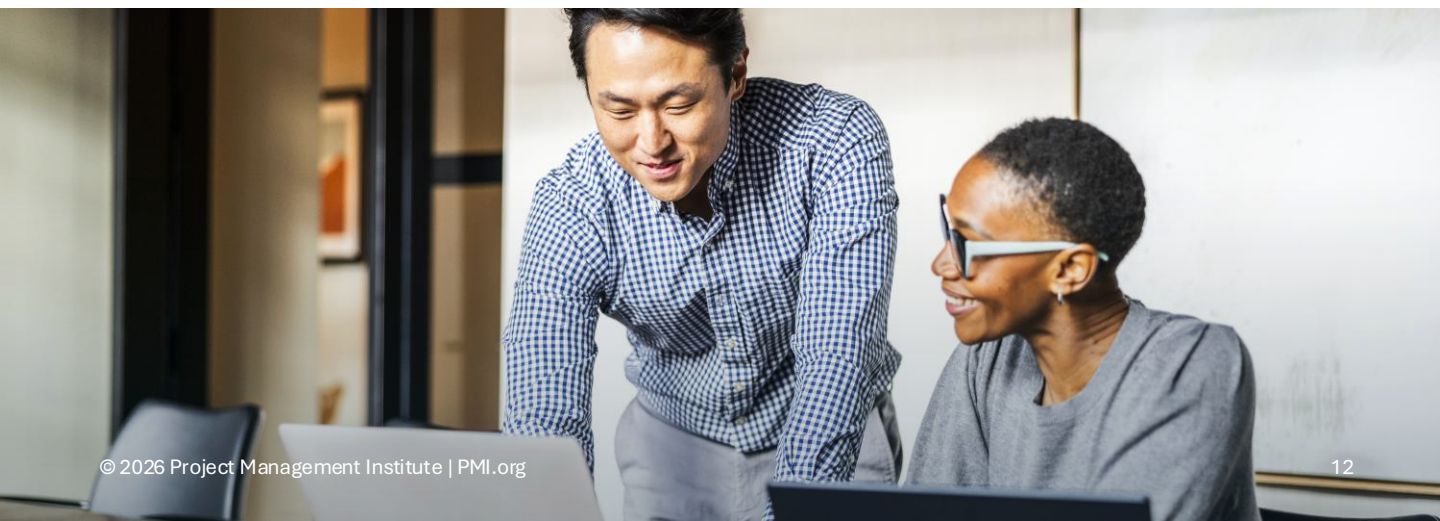
For large organizations, the challenge of building project management capability isn't usually a shortage of talent. It's the shortage of shared foundation: a common framework that holds across business units, geographies, and the inevitable turnover of people and priorities.

What Hitachi Academy built isn't a training program bolted onto the side of the organization. It's a capability infrastructure, grounded in an internationally recognized standard, connected to career progression, and designed to scale, with the certification and the capabilities reinforcing each other.

For organizations exploring whether the ATP model can do similar work for them, whether the goal is internal development, enterprise credibility or both, Hitachi's experience suggests that the most durable training investments are the ones tied to something the whole organization needs to speak.

Explore how becoming a PMI Authorized Training Partner can help your organization build that foundation: developing project-ready talent, supporting career growth, and improving delivery outcomes at scale.

[Discover the ATP program →](#)



# Learn More

Becoming a PMI Authorized Training Partner can help your organization build job-ready project talent, support internal career growth and deliver more consistent project outcomes across the enterprise.

**Connect with our team to learn how authorized training can help you meet your business goals.**

[Become an ATP](#)



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